

The next six weeks, and the work behind them.

Prepared for Jay · Frontier Organics — Local Natural Provisions · 429 McHenry Ave, Modesto CA · June 24, 2026 · 38 days to Aug 1

Two documents, in order, no pitch in either. **Part 1** is the immediate-action timeline: what gets filed, ordered, and stood up now, which external clocks that starts, and how the soft open can move up while the Aug 1 grand open holds firm. **Part 2** is a flat, side-by-side inventory of the operating work once the doors are open — what running the back office costs on your own, and what the same workstreams look like with Candelo running them. Read across each row and decide for yourself.

PART 1 · IMMEDIATE ACTION

First 72 hours → Week-1 done → soft open
pullable to ~Jul 20–22, Aug 1 anchor

PART 2 · THE WORK, COUNTED TWICE

~22–35 hr/wk + four risks on one person vs ~2–4 hr/wk of owner-only decisions

PILOT PACKET · PART 1

Fire everything now — days, not weeks.

Compressed action timeline · replaces the 6-week drip · 429 McHenry Ave, Modesto CA

FIRST 72 HRS
everything fires

SOFT OPEN
can move up

GRAND OPEN
Aug 1 anchor

Compressed action timeline — fire everything now, in parallel

The earlier board spread the opening over six tidy weeks. That pace is a choice, not a constraint. Almost everything on it is an **online form, an account, or an order** — none of which need to wait their turn. So they don't. **Everything that can start today starts today, all at once.** What's left after that isn't slow work — it's *external clocks* (an install window, a newspaper-publication run, an inspector's calendar) that were all set ticking on **Day 1** instead of in week 3.

The shape: a **first-72-hours** burst that fires every filing, order, and account in parallel, then a **Week-1-done** line where everything inside our control is finished and only the external clocks are still running. Aug 1 stays the grand-open anchor — but the soft open no longer has to wait for the last week. **If the install lands and the inspection passes early, the soft open moves up.**

Owner key: **J** = Jay (sign, pay, in-person, hire) · **C** = Candelo (systems, drafting, tracking, back office) · **C+J** = Candelo preps, Jay executes/decides in one motion · **V** = vendor/contractor (Jay engages, Candelo tracks). The point of parallelizing is that **no item waits on one person** — Candelo pre-fills and stands up in parallel while Jay signs and pays, so the only thing setting the real schedule is the agency or the install crew, not our throughput.

Confirmed by Jay's plan (so none of this is gated on research): zoning by-right (no CUP), cosmetics-only production, food = sealed resale, raw-dairy resale needs no extra license. The single regulatory long pole is the county market permit — **pre-filled and ready to fax (Doc H).**

THE FIRST 72 HOURS — everything fires at once (Jun 24–26)

Nothing here waits for anything else. These run **simultaneously**, not in sequence. Candelo pre-fills every form so Jay's only motion is sign / pay / submit.

#	OWNER	FIRE IT NOW	CLOCK IT STARTS
1	C+J	EIN online at IRS (if new entity needed) — issued in minutes	Instant — unblocks seller's permit, bank, payroll, Square
2	C+J	CDTFA seller's permit — free, online, usually same-day	Same-day to a few days
3	C+J	DBA "Frontier Organics – Local Natural Provisions" filed at County Clerk (~\$40) and the 4-week newspaper publication ordered the same hour	Publication = 4 weekly runs (~4 wks) — this is why it must be Day 1
4	C+J	City of Modesto business license application submitted	Days
5	C+J	Fax the Stanislaus County market permit (Doc H pre-fill) → 209-525-6774; call DER first (209-525-6700) re: plan-review vs straight-to-inspection + fee	DER response → sets the inspection date (the long pole)

#	OWNER	FIRE IT NOW	CLOCK IT STARTS
6	J	Order internet — AT&T Business Fiber (check 429 McHenry) or Comcast Xfinity Business; add 5G failover for POS in the same call	Install 1–2+ wks — order Day 1 so it lands early
7	J	Send the broker the insurance packet (Candelo has it ready): general liability + product liability (skincare + raw dairy) + property/contents + workers' comp	Bind in days, not weeks
8	C+J	FDA / MoCRA facility registration + product listing (Frontier Organics, Tallips, TALO); note small-business exemption + eye/oral carve-outs	Online — done in days
9	J / V	Utilities into business name (PG&E, City water/sewer, trash); order the new security system from a new company (baseline RAND ~\$220/qtr)	Utilities instant–days; security install days
10	C+J	Food handler cards for Jay + any known staff (online, ~\$15 each)	Same day
11	J	Order Square hardware + open the Square account (POS = Square, Jay's #1)	Hardware ships in days
12	C	Stand up the Control Room on Frontier's Google Workspace; load every readiness row, dated to Aug 1; stand up cold-chain temp-logging + receiving workflows for the freezers	Live same day
13	C+J	Decision call (30 min) : lock POS = Square; lock inventory = Control Room vs Craftybase (Candelo demos the production module live)	Unblocks the production-module load
By end of Day 3, every account exists, every form is filed, every order is placed, and every external clock is already running. The only things not yet <i>finished</i> are the ones no amount of effort finishes faster — they're now counting down instead of waiting in a queue.			
WEEK 1 — DONE (Jun 24–30): everything inside our control, closed out			
By the end of the first week, the back office is live and the regulatory/logistics items are filed and in flight . Candelo runs in parallel with Jay the whole time.			
OWNER	CLOSED OUT BY END OF WEEK 1		
C	Control Room live: readiness board, daily-closeout, owner dashboard, cold-chain logging, receiving — all standing and ready for data		
C	Pricing & margin sheet per category (house brands / food / goods) — keystone-on-keystone floor, target COGS ≤30%		
C	Claims / labeling review started — every house product run through green/yellow/red; no high-risk claim becomes signage/POS copy until reviewed		
C+J	EIN ✓ · seller's permit ✓ (or pending receipt) · DBA filed + publication running ✓ · business license submitted ✓ · MoCRA registered ✓ · food handler cards ✓		
J	Insurance bound (or bind date set) · internet + 5G failover ordered · utilities transferred · security ordered · Square account open + hardware inbound		
C+J	Market permit faxed ✓ — DER response being chased for the earliest inspection slot		

OWNER

CLOSED OUT BY END OF WEEK 1

C+J

Vendor & sourcing compliance kicked off — signed vendor/consignment agreements out (honey, candles, eggs, woodwork); COA collection started; raw-dairy farm's CDFA Market Milk Permit requested in writing

What's left after Week 1 is only the external clocks (below) plus the physical build-out and stocking — and those, too, were started Day 1.

THE EXTERNAL CLOCKS — what actually sets the schedule (all started Day 1)

These are the only things that can't be compressed by working faster. Each was fired in the first 72 hours, so each is counting down from the earliest possible moment.

CLOCK

LENGTH

STARTED

EARLIEST CLEAR

SETS...

DER market-permit inspection

DER's calendar after the fax

Day 1 fax

Push for a mid-July slot

The hard go/no-go for any sale

Internet install

1–2+ weeks

Day 1 order

Early–mid July

POS reliability (5G failover covers the gap)

DBA newspaper publication

4 weekly runs (~4 wks)

Day 1 filing

~Late July

When the DBA name can front sales

Insurance bind

Days

Day 1 packet

Week 1

No sale before product liability is bound

Build-out + fixtures + first freezer stock

Jay/vendor pace

Now

Compresses to fit

Floor-ready date

CAN THE SOFT OPEN MOVE UP? — yes, and here's exactly what gates it

The grand open stays **Aug 1**. But the soft open was parked at Jul 29–30 only because the old board back-loaded it. With everything fired Day 1, the soft open is gated by **three** things, not by the calendar:

1. DER inspection passed (permit in hand) — the only true blocker. Push DER for the earliest slot the day they respond.

2. Insurance bound — done in Week 1.

3. POS live — Square configured + internet in (5G failover as the safety net).

If those three clear early — realistically **mid-to-late July** if the inspector slots us in and the install lands — the soft open moves to **as early as ~Jul 20–22**, giving **10+ live days** to dial in flow, staffing, and the daily closeout before Aug 1 instead of two. The two items that *can't* be rushed by effort are the **DBA publication (~4 weeks)** and the **inspection slot** — both already running since Day 1, so they clear as early as they physically can.

Recommendation: treat inspection-slot date as the live variable. The day DER responds, lock the earliest inspection; the soft-open date follows directly from it. Everything else will already be done.

THE COMPRESSED CADENCE — at a glance

PHASE	WINDOW	STATE
First 72 hours	Jun 24–26	Every form filed, every account open, every order placed, every clock started — in parallel
Week 1 — done	Jun 24–30	Back office live; all controllable items closed; externals in flight
Clocks counting	Jul 1--~20	Install lands · insurance bound · inspection scheduled · DBA publishing · build-out + stocking
Soft open (movable up)	~Jul 20–22 (if inspection + install clear early) — fallback Jul 29–30	Live transactions; Candelo runs the back office in real time; fix what it exposes
Grand open (anchor)	Aug 1 (Sat)	Jay runs the floor; Candelo runs the operation — live inventory/COGS, cold-chain logs, daily "make/restock/fix/stop," reporting from day one

Who runs what — in one line

Jay opens it — lease, build-out, permits, inspections, insurance, hiring, the storefront. **Candelo runs it** — the Control Room and everything that operates the store: inventory, COGS, cold-chain logs, claims/MoCRA, complaints/recall, reorder, daily close, reporting, dashboards. The two tracks run **at the same time**, which is the entire point: the back office is live the moment the doors are, because it was built while the building was.

Dates are calendar-anchored to Jay's plan. Confirm fees, inspection slots, and install windows directly with each agency/vendor — those external clocks set the real critical path, and every one of them was started on Day 1.

PILOT PACKET · PART 2

The work, counted twice.

On your own vs. with Candelo running it · a plain, side-by-side inventory of the operating load

ON YOUR OWN

~22–35 hr/wk + the four risks, on one person

WITH CANDELO

~2–4 hr/wk of owner-only decisions; risks tracked

What it takes to run this — on your own, and with Candelo running it

This is a flat, factual inventory of the operating work behind a production-backed storefront. Left column: what you personally have to do, track, and carry if you run the back office yourself. Right column: what the same workstream looks like with Candelo's Control Room and operating partner handling it. No claims, no pitch — the rows are the rows. Read across each one and decide for yourself.

How to read it. Hours are **conservative weekly estimates of the recurring load once the store is open** (a separate one-time setup load is noted where it's large). "Risk carried" is the operational exposure that sits on whoever owns the row. The right column is honest about what **stays yours no matter what** — signatures, logins, payment authorization, and being the FDA Responsible Person never move; a partner can prepare the decision but can't make it for you. Where Candelo does little **by design** (the regulated rails), the row says so.

Permits & licensing

EIN · CDTFA seller's permit · DBA · city business license · county market permit · FDA/MoCRA · food handler cards

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Research each agency's process, fill 7+ separate forms, file them in the right order, track which is filed / pending / approved, chase responses, then remember every renewal date afterward.	Each form pre-filled to a one-click sign / pay / submit ; each tracked as a status row on the readiness board; renewals surfaced before they lapse. You still sign, pay, and fax — those are yours.
~40–60 hrs one-time across the open window, then ~0.5 hr/wk chasing renewals.	~0 hrs of your time beyond the signatures themselves.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> a missed filing or a lapsed permit stops sales or triggers fines.	<i>Risk:</i> a tracked board with renewal flags — a lapse has to get past a system, not just a busy memory.

Inventory · COGS · batch/lot tracking

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Build recipes/BOM, log every batch, assign lot IDs, compute weighted-average COGS by hand, and keep inventory-by-location current — or rent Craftybase at ~\$1,188/yr to do it.	The Control Room self-builds recipes, batches, lot traceability, and weighted COGS, with an append-only Material Ledger; released units transfer to the Shopify sellable location automatically. You approve recipes. Built in at \$0 .

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
~4–6 hr/wk, plus the Craftybase fee or the spreadsheet-error risk.	~0 hr/wk.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> wrong COGS → mispriced products; a broken lot trail → you can't isolate a recall.	<i>Risk:</i> current-lot traceability + costed batches that are regulator/insurer-defensible at this scale.

Cold-chain temperature logging

frozen grass-fed beef · raw dairy · eggs

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Log freezer temps on a schedule, hold the records, and personally notice any excursion.	A temp-logging + receiving workflow holds the defensible record; excursions flag. You (or a sensor) take the reading.
~2–3 hr/wk plus the discipline to never miss a day.	~0 hr/wk beyond the reading itself.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> an unlogged excursion = unsellable food and health/insurer exposure.	<i>Risk:</i> a continuous, time-stamped record instead of a memory of "I think I checked."

Recall · complaints · adverse events

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Take every complaint, judge whether it's serious, know the 15-business-day FDA serious-AE clock , trace the lot, hold the batch, and keep the comms — under pressure, on an event you didn't schedule.	Every complaint/AE logged (order ID, batch/lot, category), monitored daily, escalated to you same-day on any serious category; the lot is traced and the batch held; the record is kept. You remain the Responsible Person and own the FDA reporting decision — Candelo makes it a one-decision call inside the window.
~1–2 hr/wk baseline; spikes hard on an actual event.	~0–1 hr/wk — you decide on flagged events; the legwork is done.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> this is the highest-consequence row — a missed serious-AE window or an untraceable lot.	<i>Risk:</i> the window and the lot trail are both system-held; the decision still reaches you in time.

Daily closeout

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Reconcile the day's totals against POS, check cash over/short, and note exceptions — every single day .	Aggregated totals taken into the closeout; cash over/short auto-computed; mismatches flagged. You read the flagged exceptions. (Copied totals only — no card or bank data ever enters the system.)
~3–5 hr/wk.	~0–0.5 hr/wk.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> drift between POS and reality; cash shrink you don't catch.	<i>Risk:</i> a daily reconciled close with exceptions surfaced the same day.

Reorder · purchasing

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Watch stock, remember reorder points, time freezer restocks with the supplier, and thread the needle between stockouts and spoilage.	Reorder points set; low-stock and below-reorder flags come off the closeouts weekly. You place the orders.
~2–3 hr/wk.	~0.5 hr/wk (placing the orders).
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> stockouts (lost sales) or over-ordering perishables (spoilage).	<i>Risk:</i> reorder signals arrive before the shelf is empty.

Weekly reporting

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Pull sales by channel, margin by family, production output, waste, labor %, and tax liability into something you can actually read — by hand, weekly.	A weekly owner report is generated and sent (Google Doc), ending in what to make / restock / fix / stop. You read it and decide.
~2–3 hr/wk.	~0.25 hr/wk (reading it).
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> running on gut instead of numbers.	<i>Risk:</i> decisions teed up against current figures.

Owner dashboard

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Assemble the at-a-glance numbers from scattered tools whenever you want a read.	The dashboard refreshes daily; tiles stay current; the launch-blocker / exception list is live. You glance.
~1–2 hr/wk.	~0 hr/wk.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> no current picture between manual pulls.	<i>Risk:</i> a cockpit that's current without you assembling it.

Vendor & COA compliance

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Collect a COA per lot, verify each food vendor's permits + resale certificates, qualify new suppliers, and chase the gaps.	A supplier master runs the CoA-per-lot check, flags gaps, and qualifies new suppliers on an SOP. You sign the vendor agreements.
~1–2 hr/wk.	~0.25 hr/wk.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> an unqualified vendor or a missing COA = compliance and recall exposure.	<i>Risk:</i> every received lot is checked against a CoA on file.

Bookkeeping / QBO (the row where Candelo does the least — by design)

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
	Candelo feeds unit COGS into the system and never holds the ledger. QuickBooks Online stays the ledger of record on your accounts — it's a

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Categorize transactions, reconcile, and keep the ledger clean — or pay a bookkeeper.	regulated rail Candelo doesn't custom-build or operate. This stays you and your accountant.
~2–4 hr/wk (or the bookkeeper's fee).	~2–4 hr/wk still yours — Candelo reduces the COGS-side work, not the books themselves.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> a messy ledger at tax time.	<i>Risk:</i> unchanged on the ledger side — honestly, this rail stays with you.

Marketing / Google Business Profile

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Stand up Google Business Profile + Apple Maps, tie store social to the existing online audience, keep hours/info current.	Candelo stands up the Google Business Profile + Apple Maps and ties IG/TikTok to the existing audience. You approve voice and posts; ongoing content stays yours unless scoped in.
~1–2 hr/wk (more at launch).	Setup handled; ~1 hr/wk ongoing stays yours for content.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> invisible to local search on opening day.	<i>Risk:</i> discoverable at open; ongoing posting is still your call.

POS setup

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Choose the POS, configure registers + market mode, build the catalog, connect the channels.	Candelo configures Square (register + markets) and connects the Control Room sales feed — which is POS-agnostic (reads Square or Shopify). You hold the Square login + payment authorization.
~6–10 hrs one-time + ~0.5 hr/wk upkeep.	~0 hrs beyond holding the login.
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> a misconfigured POS at open = checkout chaos.	<i>Risk:</i> configured and connected before the doors open.

Delivery & cold-chain (in transit)

ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Plan the delivery/van, keep the cold chain intact in transit, and log it.	Delivery cold-chain logging folds into the same temp-log workflow; receiving/transfer is recorded. You (or the driver) make the run; the delivery-van plan is still an open decision of yours.
~1–2 hr/wk.	~0.5 hr/wk (the run itself).
<i>Risk carried alone:</i> a broken cold chain in transit = spoiled/unsafe product and liability.	<i>Risk:</i> a logged chain of custody from freezer to customer.

TOTALS — what each column actually costs you

	ON YOUR OWN	WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT
Recurring back-office load, once open	~22–35 hr/wk <i>(conservative)</i>	~2–4 hr/wk — signatures, logins, payment auth, gating decisions, Responsible-Person calls
One-time setup load (across the open)	~50–75 hrs of filing, configuring, building	~hours — mostly your signatures; the rest is built/pre-filled
Tooling cost	~\$1,188/yr Craftybase (or hand-built COGS risk)	\$0 for the production/COGS layer (self-built)
Compliance risk <i>(lapsed permit/claim)</i>	Held in one busy owner's memory	Tracked board + renewal flags
Recall risk <i>(untraceable lot / missed 15-day AE clock)</i>	Carried alone, under event pressure	System-held lot trail + same-day escalation; you still decide
Cash risk <i>(undetected over/short, shrink)</i>	Caught only if you reconcile that day	Daily reconciled close, exceptions flagged
Stockout risk <i>(lost sales / spoiled perishables)</i>	Watched by hand	Reorder-point flags before the shelf empties

The one-line read: roughly a **half-time-job's worth of recurring operating work** — plus the four named risks — sits on one person if the back office is run solo. With Candelo running it, the recurring work drops to **a few hours a week of owner-only decisions**, and the risks move from *remembered* to *tracked*. What stays yours is exactly what should: the signatures, the money authorizations, the logins, and the legal Responsible-Person calls. **The regulated rails — payments, payroll, the ledger, banking, insurance, tax filing, security — never move; they stay on your accounts with proven vendors. Candelo operates the overlay, not the rails.**

The imbalance in these rows isn't an argument. It's just the work, counted twice.

Reusable as the Candelo AI Operations Partner value-demonstration template — swap the workstreams and the hour estimates per client; keep the two-column, count-it-twice structure. Estimates are conservative and client-specific; confirm against each business's real volume. Not legal or tax advice — worker classification and entity/tax elections are fact-specific; confirm with a California employment attorney and a CPA.